

The SARE

Simple Agreement for Research Equity

A Funding Mechanism for Nonprofit
Research Organisations

Executive Summary

Traditional funding models fail a critical class of scientific organisations. Government grants impose rigid timelines and narrow scope. Venture capital demands rapid commercialisation, creating misaligned incentives that compromise open science. Philanthropic grants provide freedom but offer donors no mechanism for financial return if their bet on basic research yields commercial breakthroughs.¹

Recent experience with Focused Research Organisations (FROs), a class of US nonprofit research labs structured with startup-like urgency but freed from shareholder pressure, shows what becomes possible when the right capital meets the right structure.² The category has already proven its commercial potential: in January 2026, Merge Labs spun out of the FRO Forest Neurotech with \$252 million in seed funding at an \$850 million valuation.³ FROs are not the only shape a serious nonprofit research organisation can take, but they offer the clearest worked example of why an instrument like the SARE is needed.

Yet a fundamental question remains unanswered: **How do early philanthropic funders participate in the value they helped create?**

The **SARE—Simple Agreement for Research Equity**—addresses this gap. Modelled on Y Combinator's transformative SAFE instrument, the SARE is a contractual agreement between a funder and a nonprofit research organisation. The funder provides early-stage investment capital. In return, the funder receives a contractual right to equity in any for-profit entity that spins out of the research organisation. If no qualifying spin-out occurs by a long-stop date, the contribution is then treated as a donation to the organisation.

Synconetics, a Swiss-registered Verein (association) pursuing consciousness continuity engineering, is the first organisation to implement the SARE as its primary funding mechanism. Synconetics is a nonprofit research organisation in its own right, not a Convergent Research FRO, but it draws on the same insight that motivated the FRO movement: that ambitious basic science needs a structure which combines startup focus with nonprofit freedom. This document presents the instrument's design, legal framework, and strategic rationale.

1. William Blair, "Venture Philanthropy: A New Era of Innovative Giving" (2026).

https://www.williamblair.com/-/media/downloads/pwm/2026/williamblair_venture-philanthropy-a-new-era-innovative-giving.pdf

2. Federation of American Scientists, "Focused Research Organizations: A New Model for Scientific Research."

<https://fas.org/publication/focused-research-organizations-a-new-model-for-scientific-research/>

3. WIRED, "Sam Altman Brain-Computer Interface Merge Labs" (Dec 2025).

<https://www.wired.com/story/sam-altman-brain-computer-interface-merge-labs-spin-out-nonprofit-forest-neurotech/>

The SAFE: Origins & Impact

In late 2013, Y Combinator introduced the Simple Agreement for Future Equity (SAFE), a financial instrument that would reshape Silicon Valley's approach to early-stage funding.⁴ Before the SAFE, startups and investors relied on convertible notes—debt instruments with interest rates, maturity dates, and repayment obligations that added unnecessary complexity to seed-stage deals.

How the SAFE Works

The SAFE's mechanics are deliberately simple. An investor provides capital to a startup. In return, the investor receives the right to future equity upon a triggering event—typically the next priced funding round or a liquidity event such as an acquisition or IPO. Crucially, the SAFE carries no interest, no maturity date, and no repayment obligation. Until conversion, SAFE holders have no voting rights or ownership.⁵

Three key terms define a SAFE:

- **Valuation Cap:** The maximum company valuation at which the SAFE converts to equity, protecting early investors from dilution.
- **Discount Rate:** A percentage discount on the share price at conversion, rewarding the investor for early risk.
- **Most Favoured Nation (MFN):** Ensures the SAFE holder receives terms at least as favourable as those offered in subsequent SAFEs.

The Post-Money SAFE (2018)

In 2018, Y Combinator updated the SAFE to a “post-money” version. Under this model, the investor's ownership percentage is fixed at the time of signing, providing greater clarity about dilution. Post-money SAFEs are considered more investor-friendly, while the original pre-money SAFEs remain more founder-friendly but less transparent about ultimate ownership stakes.⁶

Impact on the Startup Ecosystem

The SAFE's impact has been transformative. Today, it is used by “almost all YC startups and countless non-YC startups” as the primary instrument for early-stage fundraising.⁷ Its simplicity—a single document requiring minimal negotiation—dramatically reduced legal fees and closing times.

Perhaps most significantly, the SAFE enabled “high-resolution fundraising”: the ability to close with individual investors independently, as they are ready, rather than coordinating a single round. This innovation accelerated the pace of startup formation and lowered barriers to entry for both founders and angel investors.⁷

The SARE adapts this proven instrument for a fundamentally different context: **early-stage investment in nonprofit research organisations with commercial spin-out potential.**

4. Y Combinator, "Startup Documents." <https://www.ycombinator.com/documents>

5. Wikipedia, "Simple agreement for future equity." https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Simple_agreement_for_future_equity

6. Carta, "Understanding SAFEs." <https://carta.com/learn/startups/fundraising/convertible-securities/safes/>

7. Y Combinator, "Startup Documents." <https://www.ycombinator.com/documents>

Context: The FRO Movement and Why the SARE Is Needed

Origins in Crisis

The Focused Research Organisation model traces its roots to the COVID-19 pandemic. In 2020, Patrick Collison (Stripe CEO) and collaborators established a \$50M+ Fast Grants fund, distributing some grants in under 48 hours, demonstrating that the bottleneck in scientific progress was not talent or ideas, but funding mechanisms.⁸ This experience catalysed Eric and Wendy Schmidt, through Schmidt Futures, to support the creation of Convergent Research in 2021.⁹

What is a Focused Research Organisation?

Convergent Research, a US-based 501(c)(3) nonprofit, pioneered and now operates the FRO model—a “non-profit science studio” that launches standalone research organisations designed to solve specific, well-defined scientific problems.⁹ FROs are one expression of a broader idea, not the only one. Synconetics shares the underlying motivation but operates as an independent Swiss nonprofit research organisation rather than as a Convergent Research subsidiary.

FROs share a distinctive set of characteristics worth understanding, because they illustrate the funding gap the SARE is designed to close:

- **Startup structure:** A founding team (CEO, CTO, COO), interdisciplinary researchers, and professional operations.
- **Scale:** Typically 15–30 researchers with \$30–50M total budgets (\$6–10M/year burn rates).
- **Time-bounded:** Designed as 4–7 year projects with clear milestones and deliverables.
- **Legal structure:** Organised as LLCs, subsidiary to Convergent Research (the parent 501(c)(3)).
- **Public goods output:** Open-access datasets, protocols, tools, and research papers—not immediately profitable products.¹⁰
- **Support infrastructure:** Convergent provides governance, nonprofit setup, accounting, legal, HR, and tech transfer support.

The key innovation FROs demonstrate is combining **startup urgency with nonprofit freedom**: operating with the intensity and focus of a startup while remaining insulated from commercial incentive structures that might compromise the integrity of basic research.¹¹ This is the operating principle Synconetics adopts as well, while remaining structurally independent of the Convergent Research family.

Known FROs

FRO	Focus Area
E11 Bio	Connectomics
Cultivarium	Synthetic biology
Forest Neurotech	Ultrasound brain-computer interfaces
PTI	Research infrastructure
EvE Bio	Biological research
Lean FRO	Research methodology
[C] Worthy	Carbon research

International Expansion

The FRO model is now expanding internationally. In the UK, the Advanced Research and Invention Agency (ARIA), a government body modelled on DARPA, has partnered with Convergent Research as an “activation partner,” signalling institutional validation of the model.⁹

The Spin-Out Potential

Critically, FROs do not restrict founding teams from pursuing venture creation after the research window concludes. If tenable, startups can be spun out to further benefit public good output. Forest Neurotech’s transformation into Merge Labs is the first major proof that this pattern works, and it raises urgent questions about how early funders of any nonprofit research organisation, FRO or otherwise, should participate in the value they helped create.¹² The SARE is Synconetics’ answer to that question.

8. The Science Entrepreneur, “The Rise of the FRO.” <https://www.science-entrepreneur.com/blog-posts/the-rise-of-the-fro>

9. Convergent Research, “Announcing Our New Collaboration with ARIA.”

<https://www.convergentresearch.org/resources/convergent/announcing-our-new-collaboration-with-aria-as-an-activation-partner>

10. UIDP, “Focused Research Organizations: A New Model for Building Scientific Infrastructure.”

<https://uidp.org/3-minute-read-focused-research-organizations-a-new-model-for-building-scientific-infrastructure/>

11. FAS, “Focused Research Organizations.”

<https://fas.org/publication/focused-research-organizations-a-new-model-for-scientific-research/>

12. Essential Technology Blog, “The Future of Focused Research Organizations.”

<https://www.essentialtechnology.blog/p/the-future-of-focused-research-organizations>

Case Study: Forest Neurotech → Merge Labs

The transformation of Forest Neurotech into Merge Labs represents the single most important validation of the FRO-to-company pipeline—and the clearest illustration of why the SARE is needed.

Forest Neurotech: The Nonprofit Phase

Forest Neurotech was founded in 2023 as a Focused Research Organisation through Convergent Research, based in Los Angeles, California. Led by CEO Sumner Norman and Chief Scientific Officer Tyson Aflalo, with Caltech bioengineering researcher Mikhail Shapiro as advisor, the organisation developed ultrasound-based brain-computer interface technology, a non-invasive alternative to electrode-based approaches like Neuralink's.¹³

The team's device, Forest-1, uses ultrasound to image brain activity by detecting changes in blood flow rather than measuring electrical activity directly. This approach enables longer-range detection and broader brain activity data collection.¹⁴

Philanthropic Funders

Forest Neurotech's research was funded entirely by philanthropic sources:¹⁵

- **Eric and Wendy Schmidt** (via Schmidt Futures / Schmidt Sciences)
- **Kenneth C. Griffin** (Citadel founder/CEO, via Griffin Catalyst)
- **Riley & Susan Bechtel Foundation**
- **James Fickel**
- **ARIA** (UK government's Advanced Research and Invention Agency)
- An **anonymous donor**

The Spin-Out: Merge Labs

On December 19, 2025, WIRED reported that a for-profit company was being spun out of Forest Neurotech. On January 15, 2026, Merge Labs officially launched with a **\$252 million seed round** at an approximate **\$850 million valuation**.¹³

Investors and co-founders:

Investors	Co-Founders
OpenAI (largest check)	Sam Altman (OpenAI CEO)
Bain Capital	Alex Blania (Tools for Humanity / World)
Interface Fund	Sandro Herbig (Tools for Humanity / World)
Fifty Years	Tyson Aflalo (Forest Neurotech CSO)

Gabe Newell (Valve)	Sumner Norman (Forest Neurotech CEO)
	Mikhail Shapiro (Caltech)

Notably, Sam Altman serves as co-founder but reportedly did not make a personal investment. Forest Neurotech continues to operate as a nonprofit research organisation alongside Merge Labs, and OpenAI will contribute scientific foundation models and frontier tools to the effort.¹⁶

A safety trial for the ultrasound BCI technology is underway in the UK, supported by ARIA.¹⁴

The Unanswered Question

This case proves the FRO model works: early-stage funding de-risks ambitious research, and once the science reaches engineering maturity, a for-profit entity can be spun out to attract venture capital at scale. But it leaves a critical question unanswered:

Did the original philanthropic funders—Eric Schmidt, Kenneth Griffin, the Bechtel Foundation, James Fickel—receive equity in Merge Labs? If so, under what terms? If not, why not?

This is exactly the gap the SARE addresses. Had a SARE been in place, these funders would hold contractual rights to equity in Merge Labs, proportional to their early investment—without having compromised the nonprofit research mission during Forest Neurotech’s critical development years.

13. WIRED, "Sam Altman Brain-Computer Interface Merge Labs Spin-Out" (Dec 2025). <https://www.wired.com/story/sam-altman-brain-computer-interface-merge-labs-spin-out-nonprofit-forest-neurotech/>

14. SiliconANGLE, "OpenAI Invests in Brain-Computer Interface Developer Merge Labs" (Jan 2026). <https://siliconangle.com/2026/01/15/openai-invests-brain-computer-interface-developer-merge-labs/>

15. Essential Technology Blog, "Announcing Merge Labs." <https://www.essentialtechnology.blog/p/announcing-merge-labs>

16. Nature, "Merge Labs Launch" (2026). <https://www.nature.com/articles/d41586-026-00329-x>

The SARE: Simple Agreement for Research Equity

Definition

A **SARE** is a contractual agreement between a funder and a nonprofit research organisation. The funder provides investment capital. In return, the funder receives a contractual right to equity in a for-profit entity that spins out of the research organisation. The SARE is a security: it is offered privately to accredited or professional investors under available exemptions, not registered or marketed to the public. It carries no interest, no maturity date, and no repayment right. If no qualifying spin-out occurs by a long-stop date, the contribution is then treated as a donation to the organisation.

Is the SARE a Security?

Yes. Under tests such as the US Howey test, an arrangement in which someone invests money in a common enterprise expecting profit from the efforts of others is a security, whatever it is called. The SARE meets that description, and it is both more honest and safer to treat it as one. Being a security is not an obstacle: almost every early-stage instrument, including the SAFE, is a security. In practice a SARE is simply offered through a private placement to accredited or professional investors under standard exemptions (for example Regulation D and Regulation S in the US), rather than registered or marketed publicly. It must never be offered to the general public or to unaccredited investors without specific advice. The tax treatment of the SARE is novel and unsettled in every relevant jurisdiction, so each investor should take their own legal and tax advice.

How a SARE-Backed Organisation Must Be Run

A SARE only works inside an organisation run a particular way. Open science is the foundation, not a feature: the organisation publishes its research openly, which is what makes the nonprofit genuinely charitable, protects its tax-exempt status, and keeps it independent of investor pressure. The moat must come from the team and from what the spin-out builds for itself, never from the charity withholding knowledge. The organisation runs two strictly separate funding tracks: genuine tax-exempt donations from people who want no return, and SARE investments from people who want upside, kept on separate ledgers so the investment track never contaminates the donation track. The investment track is a securities offering, sold privately to accredited investors. SARE holders fund the research but do not govern it. When research matures into a for-profit spin-out, the nonprofit must receive fair value for what it contributes, as an arm's-length originator or incubation stake, so insiders are not taking the charity's value cheaply; the nonprofit's stake stays charitable and any proceeds return to its mission. The organisation should be candid that the instrument's tax treatment is uncertain and direct investors to their own advisers.

SAFE vs. SARE: A Structural Comparison

Feature	SAFE	SARE
Entity type	For-profit startup	Nonprofit research org
Capital type	Investment	Investment (treated as a donation only if no spin-out occurs)
Revenue during R&D	Possible	Possible (no profit distribution)
Open science	Not required	Mandated
IP ownership	Company owns	Open/shared during nonprofit phase
Conversion trigger	Priced funding round	Spin-out's first priced round (or earlier liquidity event)
Investor rights pre-conversion	None	None (no control of the nonprofit)
Time horizon	1–3 years typical	3–7+ years

Core Terms of a SARE

1. Investment Amount

Cash, cryptocurrency, or in-kind contributions to the nonprofit research organisation.

2. Conversion Trigger

The spin-out's first priced equity round, or an earlier liquidity event such as an acquisition. The SARE behaves like a standard SAFE held against the spin-out.

3. Equity Allocation

Converts into equity of the spin-out on standard SAFE terms, set by a valuation cap and/or discount agreed at the time of the SARE.

4. Valuation Cap

Maximum valuation at which the SARE converts to equity, protecting early investors from excessive dilution at spin-out.

5. Open Science Mandate

All research outputs—protocols, datasets, hardware designs—remain openly published during the nonprofit phase.

6. Revenue Permission

The nonprofit may generate revenue through consulting, licensing, or grants, but cannot distribute profits to members or investors.

7. Multiple Spin-Outs

Each SARE is tied to a defined spin-out, typically the first qualifying spin-out in the relevant field. Participation across multiple spin-outs must be specified explicitly, not assumed.

8. IP Framework

All research produced in the nonprofit phase is published openly. The spin-out's advantage comes from its founding team, execution speed, head start, and the proprietary IP it develops itself after spin-out, not from exclusive rights over the open research.

9. Investor Rights

SARE holders have no governance, board, or control rights in the nonprofit, mirroring a SAFE holder's lack of rights before conversion. This protects the organisation's independence and its tax-exempt standing.

10. Dissolution Clause

If the organisation dissolves without producing a spin-out, the SARE investment is treated as a charitable donation with no recovery.

The Two-Phase Model

The SARE is designed around a two-phase organisational lifecycle that mirrors the natural progression from basic research to commercial application.

PHASE 1 — NONPROFIT RESEARCH (3–7 YEARS)

- Open science mandate: all outputs published
- Startup urgency with milestone-based progress
- Revenue generation permitted (reinvested, not distributed)
- SARE funders have no control of the nonprofit during the research phase
- No profit distribution; tax-exempt status maintained
- Research reaches engineering maturity



SARE CONVERTS TO EQUITY

PHASE 2 — COMMERCIAL SPIN-OUT

- One or more for-profit entities spun out (GmbH, AG, C-Corp, etc.)
- SARE converts to equity at the spin-out's first priced round, on the agreed cap and/or discount
- Original nonprofit can continue as research arm
- Venture capital and institutional investors enter
- Commercial product development and market entry

This two-phase model aligns incentives across all stakeholders. Early-stage funders gain a transparent path to financial return. Researchers retain nonprofit freedom during the critical basic research phase. And the broader public benefits from an open-science mandate that ensures knowledge remains accessible regardless of commercial outcomes.

The Forest Neurotech → Merge Labs transition demonstrates this model in action: years of philanthropically funded nonprofit research, followed by a for-profit spin-out that attracted \$252 million in venture capital. The SARE simply formalises the mechanism by which early funders participate in that transition.

Who Owns the Spin-Out?

A nonprofit association has no owners; it has members, and its assets are locked to its purpose. The spin-out is different: it is a for-profit company with a share register. At spin-out that register typically comprises the founders and operators as individuals, the nonprofit itself as a charitable originator stake whose value stays in the charity, the SARE holders who convert

their early funding into spin-out shares, new venture investors, and an employee option pool. The nonprofit is usually a minority holder, much as a university is in the companies it spins out. What matters is that the nonprofit is fairly compensated for its contribution and that its share of any proceeds returns to its charitable mission.

Legal Framework: Swiss Verein Implementation

Synconetics is structured as a Schweizer Verein (Swiss association)—a nonprofit, tax-exempt legal entity with a Swiss bank account. This section examines the legal mechanisms that make the SARE enforceable under Swiss law.

Swiss Verein: Legal Foundation

The Swiss Verein is governed by Articles 60 et seq. of the Swiss Civil Code. A Verein acquires legal personality as soon as the intention to exist as a corporate body is apparent from its articles of association—no formal registration is required unless the association engages in commercial activities exceeding CHF 100,000 in annual turnover.¹⁷ The Verein can hold assets, sign contracts, and act in its own name, while historically maintaining a nonprofit orientation. Swiss law permits commercial activities if properly registered.¹⁸

Key Legal Mechanisms

- **Subsidiary creation:** A Verein can own and create subsidiary companies—either a GmbH (minimum CHF 20,000 share capital) or an AG (minimum CHF 100,000 share capital)—under Swiss law. The Verein acts as founding shareholder.
- **Conversion without liquidation:** The Swiss Merger Act allows conversion between legal forms without prior liquidation. All rights and obligations transfer automatically. While direct Verein-to-GmbH/AG conversion is possible, the more common and cleaner approach is to create a subsidiary entity.
- **Tax-neutral demerger:** Swiss tax law permits tax-neutral demergers for carve-out transactions, enabling the separation of commercial activities from the nonprofit parent without triggering tax liabilities.
- **SARE as contractual obligation:** The SARE agreement constitutes a contractual obligation of the Verein, enforceable under the Swiss Code of Obligations (OR).
- **Cryptocurrency acceptance:** Switzerland's regulatory environment—particularly in Zug canton, known as "Crypto Valley"—fully permits associations to accept cryptocurrency as donations or investments.

Legality of the SARE Under Swiss Law

The SARE model is legal under Swiss law.¹⁹²⁰ Key considerations:

The SARE is a security in most jurisdictions. It is therefore offered through a private placement to accredited or professional investors under available exemptions (for example Regulation D and Regulation S in the United States, and equivalent private-placement exemptions elsewhere), rather than registered. The specific exemption and any filings should be confirmed with local securities counsel in each jurisdiction.

- Swiss law explicitly allows nonprofits to engage in commercial activities.
- Tax exemption is maintained as long as the primary purpose remains nonprofit, subject to cantonal tax office oversight.
- Upon spin-out, fair market valuation is required. The Verein receives consideration (equity in the new entity + continued access to IP).
- SARE investors receive equity in the new for-profit entity per their contractual rights.
- GmbH-to-AG conversion (if later upscaling is needed) is well-established, costs CHF 4–5K, and takes 2–4 weeks.

Important Caveats & Recommendations

- **Legal counsel:** Engage Swiss legal counsel specialising in both nonprofit and corporate law to draft the SARE template.
- **Tax-exempt status:** Ensure SARE terms do not jeopardise the Verein's tax-exempt status. Cantonal tax offices monitor compliance.
- **Independent valuation:** At spin-out time, an independent third-party valuation of transferred assets is essential.
- **Governance:** Maintain disinterested board oversight per Art. 725 seq. of the Swiss Code of Obligations.
- **Asset transfers:** State/cantonal notification may be required for substantial asset transfers from nonprofit to for-profit.
- **Nonprofit spinout best practices:** Form a special committee of disinterested directors. Structure the for-profit as a corporation (not LLC) to avoid unrelated business taxable income issues. Establish intercompany agreements for IP sharing.

17. Goldblum & Partners, "Swiss Verein." <https://goldblum.ch/knowledgebase/swiss-verein>

18. Swiss Federal Government, "Creating an Association."

<https://www.kmu.admin.ch/kmu/en/home/new/monatsthema/2023/creating-an-association-how-and-why.html>

19. LEXR, "GmbH to AG Conversion in Switzerland." <https://www.lexr.com/en-ch/blog/gmbh-ag-conversion-switzerland/>

20. Legal 500, "Carve-Out Transactions Under Swiss Law."

<https://www.legal500.com/guides/hot-topic/carve-out-transactions-particularities-under-swiss-law/>

Synconetics: First SARE Implementation

Mission

Synconetics is an early-stage nonprofit research organisation whose mission is to eliminate involuntary death through engineering consciousness continuity. The organisation aims to develop an empirically validated, continuity-preserving method for transferring a living mind to a synthetic substrate, ensuring survival of the same conscious process by preserving the unbroken four-dimensional causal chain of conscious dynamics.²¹

Structure & Status

- Legal form: Schweizer Verein (Swiss association), nonprofit, tax-exempted.
- Swiss bank account; accepts fiat and cryptocurrency.
- Open-science mandate: all protocols, datasets, and hardware designs published openly.
- First organisation to implement the SARE as its primary funding mechanism.

Research Focus

Synconetics pursues three interconnected research programmes, as outlined in the manifesto “Death is an Engineering Challenge”:²¹

- **ECP (Ectopic Cognitive Preservation):** Biohybrid neural grafts for gradual tissue replacement—maintaining continuity of conscious dynamics while transitioning biological neurons to synthetic substrates.
- **CHI (Continuity via Hemispheric Integration):** Artificial hemispheric complements via high-bandwidth brain-machine interfaces, enabling cognitive extension and eventual substrate independence.
- **Process-World-Line Verification:** Protocols for verifying that the continuity of conscious dynamics is preserved throughout any transition procedure—the fundamental scientific validation requirement.

Potential Spin-Out Paths

- Biomedical device company (neural graft hardware and implantation protocols)
- Neural interface startup (high-bandwidth brain-machine interface technology)
- IP licensing entity for clinical applications of consciousness continuity methods

21. Burger, D., Watanabe, M. “Death is an Engineering Challenge.” Substack.
<https://danburonline.substack.com/p/death-is-an-engineering-challenge>

Conclusion & Call to Action

The SARE fills a critical gap in the funding landscape for ambitious scientific research. By combining the simplicity of Y Combinator's SAFE with the mission-driven structure of the nonprofit research organisation, it creates a mechanism that:

- **Enables early investors to back high-risk basic research** while retaining contractual rights to participate in commercial outcomes, with a separate philanthropic donation track for those who want no return.
- **Preserves research integrity**—the open-science mandate and nonprofit structure insulate researchers from commercial pressures during the critical early phases of discovery.
- **Aligns incentives across stakeholders**—researchers, funders, and the public all benefit from a model that produces open knowledge first and commercial value second.
- **Is legally implementable today**—Swiss law provides a robust framework for the Verein-to-subsidary transition, and the SARE is enforceable as a contractual obligation under the Code of Obligations.

Proven by Precedent

The Forest Neurotech → Merge Labs transition proves the underlying model works: philanthropic capital de-risks ambitious research, and once the science reaches engineering maturity, for-profit entities can attract venture capital at scale. The \$252 million seed round at an \$850 million valuation demonstrates the magnitude of value that nonprofit FROs can create.²³

The venture philanthropy movement is already demonstrating that structured philanthropic investments can generate returns. The EB Research Partnership's model, where a \$500K investment grew sixfold with proceeds fully reinvested into the charity, shows that philanthropic capital and financial returns are not mutually exclusive.²⁴

Invest in the Future of Consciousness

Synconetics invites SARE investors who believe that death is an engineering challenge—and that consciousness continuity is an achievable scientific goal. Early SARE investors participate in a funding mechanism designed for the most ambitious class of scientific research: work too important to leave to chance, too fundamental to rush to market.

contact@synconetics.org | synconetics.org

23. Neurofounders, "Inside Merge Labs: BCI's Biggest New Competitor."
<https://www.neurofounders.co/articles/inside-merge-labs-bcis-biggest-new-competitor>
24. William Blair, "Venture Philanthropy" (2026).
https://www.williamblair.com/-/media/downloads/pwm/2026/williamblair_venture-philanthropy-a-new-era-innovative-giving.pdf
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<https://www.reuters.com/legal/transactional/when-mission-meets-market-navigating-nonprofit-spinouts--pracin-2026-02-11/>